

Industry connect

Hugo Barra talks Xiaomi's strategy and Jared Sewell let's us in on how tech is mingling with cricket.

Smart SOHO

Gamifying the workplace can work wonders for your employees. Read about some great examples.

Staying clued in to the Startup Scene

Where do you search for inspiration? How do you materialise that inspiration into a real project? How do you stay ahead of the curve? We tell you everything you need to know to jump headlong into the world of startups

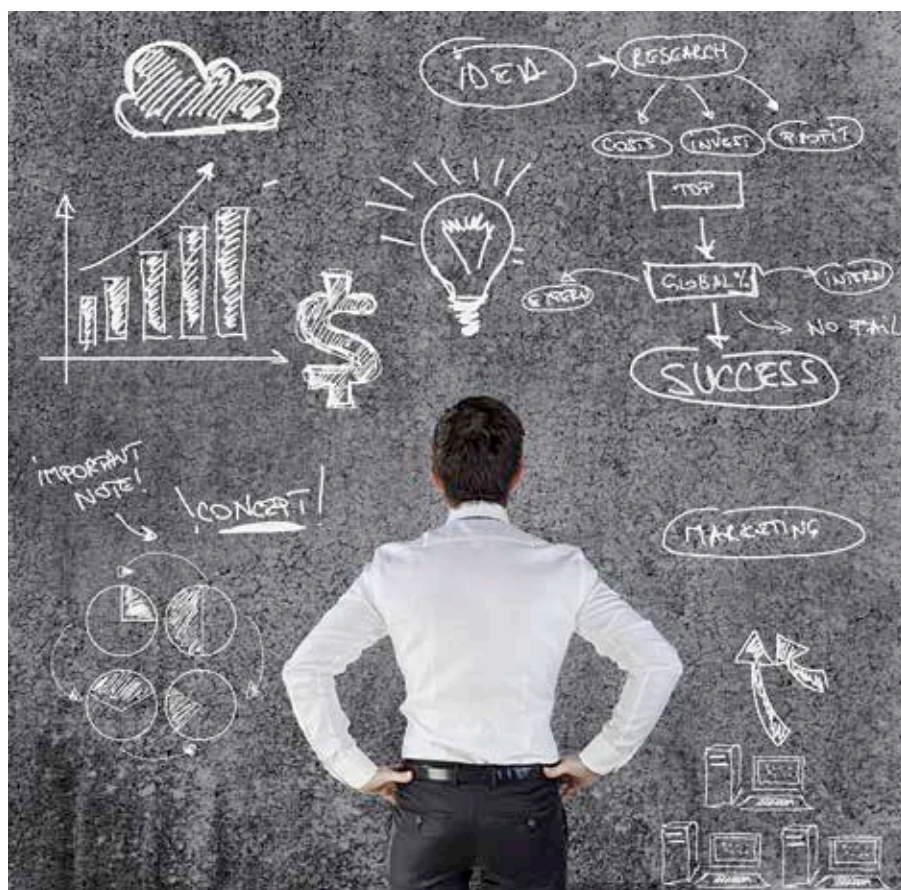
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The word 'startup' is quite liberally used nowadays. A management or engineering graduate from India probably hears the word at least once in a generic conversation, such has become the fad. While there exists a formal definition of startup in dictionaries, it's safe to say that it's impossible to encompass the idea of a startup in one prosaic definition. Any new business that aims to fill a glaring gap in the way the world functions could be categorised as a startup. The new businesses are typically high risk, start off with little or no funding and have a small team at their core. Whatever a startup is, it has caught the fancy of a major chunk of the world and has transformed the way people look at a business model. A career in a startup is exciting as is building a venture. But, how would a young student or professional keep in touch with this rapid ecosystem? Read on.

The Indian scene

It comes as no surprise that India, with its massive youth population, has finally warmed up to the idea of encouraging a startup business. What this trend has done is that it has led to a multitude of small enterprises springing up, which in turn has had a cascading effect, trickling down to colleges and educational institutions where even teenagers are dreaming of owning their own businesses and being their own bosses. Close to a decade ago, the whole idea of a startup was quite alien to the Indian popula-



An idea is the genesis of a startup

tion. Now, however, the whole climate has undergone a paradigm shift – technology has advanced, the digital divide has somewhat reduced and local talent is available in larger numbers. India always had potential with its incredible diversity and large number of avenues, but only recently have its people started exploiting this opportunity to generate revenue via large startups. Young businessmen realise that India, with its large popula-

tion, allows a business to have small margins and still generate huge profit simply due to the volume of the playing field and increasing consumption power of the Indian middle class. India is now a good place for hopeful entrepreneurs.

An idea: a genesis

For a startup of any form you need a seed, an idea. Every great and successful startup is born from a great idea, simple